

Bilawal Ali

Hyderabad, Sindh, Pakistan | +92 344 3559788 | khooharobilawalali@gmail.com
LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/bilawal-ali-0b0211245](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bilawal-ali-0b0211245) | **GitHub:** github.com/Bila-Ali

Professional Summary

SOC Analyst (L1) with hands-on experience in Security Operations Center (SOC) monitoring, SIEM tools, and incident response. Skilled in Splunk, Wazuh, and ELK Stack for log analysis, alert triage, and threat detection. Experienced in MITRE ATT&CK mapping, IOC analysis, and incident escalation workflows, with a strong foundation in network security and threat detection.

Technical Skills

SIEM & Log Analysis: Wazuh, Splunk, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), Log Correlation, Alert Triage
Threat Detection & IR: Incident Response, IOC Analysis, Threat Hunting, Alert Escalation, File Integrity Monitoring (FIM)
Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-61, Cyber Kill Chain, OWASP Top 10
Network Security: Suricata IDS, pfSense, Squid Proxy, Wireshark, TCP/IP, Network Traffic Analysis
Offensive Security Tools: Nmap, Burp Suite, Metasploit, SQLmap, Hydra, Ncrack
Forensics & Malware Analysis: Volatility, Autopsy, REMnux, FLARE-VM, YARA
Programming & Automation: Python (Pandas, Scapy, Flask), Bash Scripting
Operating Systems: Windows, Linux (Ubuntu/Debian), Kali Linux
Leveraged personal SOC lab (Splunk, Wazuh, ELK) to practice real-world alert investigation and threat detection scenarios.

Professional Experience

SOC Analyst Intern (L1)

Cyberster

Remote

- Monitored and triaged 1,000+ daily security events using Wazuh SIEM, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) through systematic alert prioritization.
- Investigated brute-force attacks, authentication anomalies, and lateral movement attempts across Linux and Windows endpoints.
- Developed 5+ custom Wazuh detection rules, improving threat detection coverage for previously unmonitored attack vectors.
- Configured File Integrity Monitoring (FIM) to detect unauthorized system changes and potential privilege escalation activity.
- Implemented Active Response policies to automatically block malicious IP addresses, reducing manual remediation workload.
- Mapped security alerts to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques; authored structured incident reports following SOC escalation procedures.

Red Team Intern

June 2024 – August 2024

ITSOLERA Pvt Ltd

Remote

- Executed 20+ vulnerability assessments and penetration tests (VAPT) against web applications using industry-standard methodologies.
- Identified and documented high-risk vulnerabilities including SQL Injection, XSS, CSRF, and broken authentication; delivered formal client reports.
- Leveraged Burp Suite for HTTP traffic interception and analysis; used Metasploit for controlled post-exploitation and privilege escalation testing.

Independent Bug Hunter

January 2024 – Present

Security Researcher

- Conducted 10+ independent vulnerability assessments across public web applications and APIs; responsibly disclosed findings to affected organizations.
- Discovered SQL Injection, XSS, and access-control flaws through manual testing with Burp Suite and custom scripts.

Projects

AI-Based PDF Malware Detection & Forensic Analysis

Mehran University (MUET)

- Built a machine learning-based malware detection system trained on 10,000+ benign and malicious PDF samples, achieving high classification accuracy.
- Integrated Explainable AI (SHAP) to surface feature importance, enabling analyst-interpretable model decisions – directly applicable to SOC triage workflows.

MailForensics – DFIR Email Analysis Platform

- Developed a Python/Streamlit forensic tool for SOC and DFIR teams to parse .eml files, extract IOCs (spoofed domains, malicious URLs), and detect phishing indicators.

SOC & Threat Simulation Lab (Splunk, Wazuh, ELK)

- Deployed and configured Splunk, Wazuh, and ELK Stack on a local lab environment for centralized log collection and analysis.
- Integrated endpoints, firewalls (pfSense), and IDS (Suricata) to simulate real SOC data sources.
- Performed log analysis, alert triage, and threat detection using SIEM dashboards and queries.
- Simulated attacks including SSH brute-force and malware payloads to validate detection rules and response workflows.
- Developed incident response playbooks aligned with NIST SP 800-61.

Certifications

- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH – PFTP) | *Medal & Certificate Awarded*
- Professional Offensive Operations – Hack The Box (Pro Lab)
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
- Intro to Splunk (eLearning) – Splunk (2026)
- Junior Cybersecurity Analyst Career Path – Cisco Networking Academy
- Endpoint Security – Cisco Networking Academy
- Introduction to Cybersecurity – Cisco Networking Academy
- Networking Basics – Cisco Networking Academy
- OPSWAT Cybersecurity Fundamentals Associate
- Ethical Hacking Essentials – EC-Council

Achievements

- **QUEST CTF 2026** – 1st Place: Secured top ranking in a competitive university-level Capture The Flag cybersecurity competition.
- **NADRA Bug Bounty Challenge 2026** – Consolation Prize (Team Lead): Led a team in a national-level bug bounty program organized by Pakistan’s National Database and Registration Authority; identified and responsibly reported live vulnerabilities.
- **Ignite CTF Hackathon** – Ranked 29th nationally with Muet Cyber Squad in a real-world cybersecurity challenge.
- **Hands-On Platforms:** 150+ labs on PortSwigger Web Security Academy; active on Hack The Box and TryHackMe (SOC, Blue Team, and Red Team paths).

Education

Mehran University of Engineering & Technology (MUET) <i>Bachelor of Science in Cyber Security</i>	Jamshoro, Pakistan <i>CGPA: 3.31 / 4.0</i>
---	---

Languages & Soft Skills

Languages: English (Professional Proficiency) Urdu (Fluent) Sindhi (Native)
Soft Skills: Analytical Thinking Incident Documentation Problem Solving Team Collaboration Leadership Time Management Attention to Detail Communication